



The 3D printer is by far the biggest attraction of any makerspace. They cost upwards of Rs 1 lakh but locally made options come cheaper

Fab Labs follow a charter of requirements regarding space, tools and curriculum laid down by founder Neil Gershenfeld at the Center for Bits and Atoms in MIT's Media Lab around 2005. There is a core set of tools including basic electronics equipment, a lasercutter, a vinyl cutter, a CNC router, a CNC milling machine, etc to allow novice makers to make almost anything. Workbench Projects is a registered Fab Lab. "Within the first three months of its operations, we were invited by Bangalore Metro Rail Corporation (BMRL) to activate one of their public spaces by conducting weekly workshops that we had initiated," explains Prakash. Later, the city railway corporation offered them the opportunity to bid for one of their spaces under the Halasuru metro station where it currently operates from. As per the Fab Lab charter, Workbench is allowed to charge only a nominal rate from the community of makers.

Maker's Asylum too charges members Rs 3,000 for a monthly membership. The token amount, says Chhabra, is just to ensure people are serious about safety, machines and making. In Delhi, Nuts and Boltz follows the same pricing for memberships. Founder Varun Heta who started the makerspace after experiencing the want of a community while teaching himself robotics.

How the space works is so; members sign up and the cost gives them access to the space, tools and community. With digital manufacturing tools, members must go through a training to ensure they know how it works and are aware of safety regulations. They are then free to use the tools on